Carb Counting Pocket Guide

Carbohydrates raise blood glucose the most. Counting grams helps match food to insulin or medication plans. Values are typical averages — always check labels.

15g	45–60g	15–20g
1 CARB SERVING (EXCHANGE)	COMMON MEAL STARTING POINT*	COMMON SNACK RANGE*

Typical carbs per serving

FOOD	PORTION	CARBS	FOOD	PORTION	CARBS
Bread	1 slice	**15g**	Rice, cooked	⅓ cup	**15g**
Tortilla	6-inch	**15g**	Pasta, cooked	⅓ cup	**15g**
Potato	½ cup	**15g**	Beans, cooked	½ cup	**15–20g**
Milk	1 cup	**12g**	Yogurt, plain	¾–1 cup	**12–15g**
Apple / orange	1 small	**15g**	Banana	½ large	**15g**
Grapes	17 small	**15g**	Fruit juice	½ cup	**15g**
Cereal, dry	~¾ cup	**15–30g**	Oatmeal, cooked	½ cup	**15g**
Crackers	4–6	**15g**	Ice cream	½ cup	**15–20g**

Usually little / no carb

- Non-starchy vegetables (most)
- Meat, poultry, fish, eggs
- Cheese, oils, butter
- Nuts & seeds (watch portions)
- Water, black coffee, unsweet tea

Label reading tips

- Use **Total Carbohydrate**, not just sugar
- Multiply by the servings you eat
- Fiber & sugar alcohols: ask your educator how you count them
- “Net carbs” marketing varies — verify math

*Meal/snack targets vary widely. Work with a dietitian for your insulin-to-carb ratio or medication plan.